

JOSHUA BUDLENDER

SALDRU, School of Economics, University of Cape Town
joshua.budlender@uct.ac.za · www.joshbudlender.co.za

FIELDS	Labour Economics, Development Economics, Applied Microeconometrics		
APPOINTMENTS	Southern Africa Labour & Development Research Unit (SALDRU), University of Cape Town		
	▪ Senior Research Officer		Jul 2026 – present
	▪ Postdoctoral Research Fellow		Jul 2024 – Jun 2026
	▪ Junior Research Fellow		Aug 2021 – Jun 2024
	▪ Researcher		Feb 2015 – Jul 2015
	Socio-Economic Rights Institute of South Africa (SERI)		
	▪ Research Fellow		Aug 2015 – Jul 2016
EDUCATION	University of Massachusetts, Amherst		
	▪ PhD, Economics		Sep 2024
	• Committee: Arindrajit Dube (chair), Daniele Girardi, Matt Woerman		
	University College London (UCL)		
	▪ MSc, Economic Policy		Sep 2017
	University of Cape Town		
	▪ BSocSci (Honours), Economics		Dec 2014
	▪ BSocSci, Economics & Economic History		Dec 2013
PUBLICATIONS	JOURNAL ARTICLES		
& CONFERENCES	[4] I. Bassier, <u>J. Budlender</u> and M. Goldman (2025). “Social Distress and (Some) Relief: Estimating the impact of pandemic job loss on poverty in South Africa” <i>International Journal of Microsimulation</i> , DOI: 10.34196/ijm.00312.		
	[3] I. Bassier, <u>J. Budlender</u> , R. Zizzamia and R. Jain (2023). “The labour market and poverty impacts of covid-19 in South Africa” <i>South African Journal of Economics</i> , DOI: 10.1111/saje.12356.		
	[2] I. Bassier, <u>J. Budlender</u> , R. Zizzamia, M. Leibbrandt, V. Ranchhod (2020). “Locked down and locked out: Repurposing social assistance as emergency relief to informal workers” <i>World Development</i> , DOI: 10.1016/j.worlddev.2020.105271.		
	[1] I. Turok, <u>J. Budlender</u> , and J. Visagie (2018). “Urban ‘Slums’ and Social Mobility” <i>Development Policy Review</i> , 36(6): 703-725.		
	WORKING PAPERS		
	[6] I. Bassier and <u>J. Budlender</u> (2025). “When do employers share? Rent sharing, monopsony and minimum wages” (CEP Discussion Paper 2134). London: Centre for Economic Performance, London School of Economics.		
	[5] <u>J. Budlender</u> (2024). “Surviving in the dark: the mortality effects of reducing rolling blackouts” (WIDER Working Paper 2024/44). Helsinki: UNU-WIDER.		
	[4] I. Bassier and <u>J. Budlender</u> (2024). “Stimulus effects of a large public employment programme” (AFD Research Paper 305). Agence française de développement.		
	[3] <u>J. Budlender</u> and A. Ebrahim (2021). “Estimating employment responses to South Africa’s Employment Tax Incentive” (WIDER Working Paper 2021/118). Helsinki: UNU-WIDER.		
	[2] <u>J. Budlender</u> (2019). “Markups and Market Structure in South Africa: What can be learnt from new administrative data?” (WIDER Working Paper 2019/58). Helsinki: UNU-WIDER.		
	[1] <u>J. Budlender</u> , M. Leibbrandt, and I. Woolard (2015). “South African poverty lines: a review and two new money-metric thresholds” (SALDRU Working Paper 151). Cape Town: Southern Africa Labour and Development Research Unit.		

SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

- [4] Surplus labour and structural transformation after land dispossession (with Ihsaan Bassier and Surbhi Kesar)
- [3] When the lights stay on: Electricity reliability and house prices (with Allan Davids)
- [2] Irregular imputation and implausible households in the 2022 South African Census (with Amy Thornton)
- [1] Racial segregation in South African formal sector firms (with Ihsaan Bassier) (*draft available on request*)

REPORTS

- [5] M. Goldman, I. Bassier, J. Budlender, L. Mzankomo, I. Woolard and M. Leibbrandt (2021). “Simulation of options to replace the special COVID-19 Social Relief of Distress grant and close the poverty gap at the food poverty line” (WIDER Working Paper 2021/165). Helsinki: UNU-WIDER.
- [4] I. Bassier and J. Budlender (2021). “Methods for credible evaluation of programme stimulus effects in South Africa” (SALDRU Working Paper 278). Cape Town: Southern Africa Labour and Development Research Unit.
- [3] J. Budlender and A. Ebrahim (2020). “Industry classification in the South African tax microdata” (WIDER Working Paper 2020/99). Helsinki: UNU-WIDER.
- [2] J. Budlender (2016). *Edged Out: Spatial Mismatch and Spatial Justice in South Africa’s Main Urban Areas – Technical Report*. Johannesburg: Socio-Economic Rights Institute of South Africa.
- [1] J. Budlender and L. Royston (2016). *Edged Out: Spatial Mismatch and Spatial Justice in South Africa’s Main Urban Areas*. Johannesburg: Socio-Economic Rights Institute of South Africa.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- [6] J. Budlender, “Surviving in the dark: the mortality effects of reducing rolling blackouts,” for the *2025 Centenary Conference of the Economic Society of South Africa*. Economic Society of South Africa: Somerset West, Sep 2025.
- [5] I. Bassier and J. Budlender, “Stimulus effects of a large public employment programme,” for the *Inequality, Work and Nature Conference*. Agence Française de Développement Group: Cape Town, Nov 2023.
- [4] J. Budlender and I. Bassier, “Monopsony, wage floors and structural transformation,” for the *2023 Biennial Conference of the Economic Society of South Africa*. Economic Society of South Africa: Pretoria, Sep 2023.
- [3] I. Bassier, J. Budlender and M. Leibbrandt, “Stimulus effects of public social programmes,” for the *2023 Biennial Conference of the Economic Society of South Africa*. Economic Society of South Africa: Pretoria, Sep 2023.
- [2] J. Budlender, M. Leibbrandt, and I. Woolard, “Weakly relative poverty lines in developing countries: The case of South Africa,” for the *2015 Biennial Conference of the Economic Society of South Africa*. Economic Society of South Africa: Cape Town, Sep 2015.
- [1] J. Budlender, M. Leibbrandt, and I. Woolard, “A “Weakly Relative” Poverty Line for South Africa,” for the *Workshop on Measuring Deprivation in order to Promote Human Development in South Africa*. Academy of Science of South Africa: Muldersdrift, Jun 2015.

GRANTS

Urban and Regional Economics in Africa Research Grant, IGC

- The value of reliable electricity: The impact of load shedding mitigation on property prices in Cape Town (2025-26)

SRG Research Grant, STEG

- Monopsony, Wage Floors, and Structural Transformation (2023-24)

RFI Research Grant, EU-AFD

- Stimulus effects of a large public employment programme (2021-23)

SA-TIED Research Grants, UNU-WIDER

- Firms and racial segregation in the South African formal sector labour market (2025)
- Economic and social costs of rolling blackouts in South Africa (2023-24)
- Monopsony, Wage Floors, and Structural Transformation (2022-23)
- Project on the South African Employment Tax Incentive (2020-21)
- Industry classification in the South African tax microdata (2019-20)
- The market structure-profit relationship in South Africa: Evidence from administrative data (2018-19)

TEACHING	Lecturer , Analysis of Household Survey Data (ECO4027S), Honours, UCT	2026
	SUPERVISION	
	▪ Doctoral: Zukile Sokapase (in progress) ▪ Honours: Mnqobi Fihlela (in progress), Zikhona Mahlambi (in progress)	
	TEACHING ASSISTANCE	
	▪ Introductory Microeconomics (ECO1110F, ECO1010S, ECO1007S), UCT. • Head Tutor 2013 – 2014 ▪ Public Sector Economics (ECO3023F), UCT. • Head Tutor	2012 – 2014 2014
AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS	▪ Fulbright Scholarship, Fulbright Foreign Student Program Full-tuition scholarship with stipend (2 years), for PhD at the University of Massachusetts, Amherst. ▪ Doctoral Abroad Scholarship, National Research Foundation (South Africa) Scholarship with stipend (4 years), for PhD at the University of Massachusetts, Amherst. ▪ Chevening Scholarship, United Kingdom Foreign & Commonwealth Office Full-tuition scholarship with stipend (1 year), for MSc at University College London (UCL). ▪ Thembi Losi Memorial Prize, School of Economics, University of Cape Town For best Honours Long Paper with a developmental theme. ▪ Undergraduate Winner, Nedbank & Old Mutual Budget Speech Competition National Economics essay-writing competition, with interview component for top-10.	2017 2017 2016 2014 2013
SERVICE	REFEREING	
	Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Development Economics, Review of Social Economy, South African Journal of Economics, Development Southern Africa, Acta Juridica	
	PROGRAMME LEADERSHIP	
	Workstream co-lead: Poverty, inequality and labour markets, SA-TIED	2026 – 2029
	CONFERENCE ORGANISATION	
	Co-convenor, annual SALDRU–ERSA December Workshop	
MEMBERSHIPS	<i>Council for the Advancement of the South African Constitution</i> (Executive Committee), <i>Economic Society of South Africa</i>	
REFERENCES	Available on request.	